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China Auto Parts & Equipment

Tesla Optimus Update from an Auto-Parts Perspective

CITI'S TAKE

Tesla Optimus team recently audited China component suppliers Joyson, Sanhua and Tuopu, potentially moving these suppliers from provisional status to certified mass production partners, according to TESLARATI ([link](#), 20-Sep). The audit reportedly came with fresh orders at an initial batch of around 5,000 units. The weekly production run-rate of Tesla Optimus was ~500 units at mid-Sep, which is targeted to reach ~1,000 units at end-Sep and 2,000-2,500 units in 4Q26E. We view the China audits and upcoming production ramp-up as positive for China Optimus suppliers and may boost investor sentiment on the robotics theme after valuation de-rating since end-May. We estimate 2027E NP exposure to the leading US humanoid robot manufacturer for following suppliers: Joyson (5.0%) > Tuopu (4.5%) > Xusheng (3.1%) > Sanhua (3.0%) and that of 2028E: Joyson (8.6%) > Tuopu (8.2%) > Xusheng (5.8%) > Sanhua (5.3%), by assuming 100k/300k robot production volume in 2027/28E (Figure 2-4).

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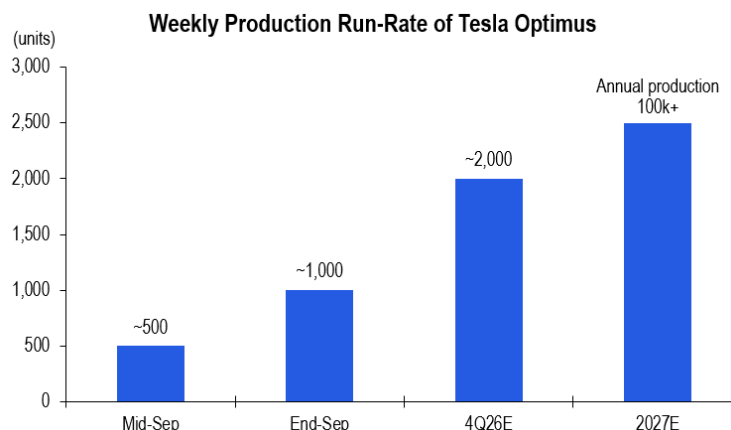
Beyond Tesla Optimus, we also note a flurry of domestic humanoid robot updates across Xpeng, Hesai and Chery that warrant investor attention.

Xpeng humanoid robot IRON plans to kick off mass-production by end-2026, with monthly production capacity ramping to several thousand units in 2027. Further readings: (1) [Xpeng \(XPEV.N/9868.HK\) - 3Q Volume Guidance Miss; Expect 4Q Monthly Sales over 60k units](#); (2) [XPeng \(XPEV.N\) - Humanoid Robot Financing Kicks Off \(Size comparable to Unitree\)](#). **Hesai's actuator modules shipments** are expected at ~50k units in Aug-Dec 2026 (ASP ~Rmb3k); current gross margin of actuator stands at 41-44%. Given Hesai is the dexterous hands actuator supplier of Sharpa, we think Sharpa Robotics may serve as a potential valuation catalyst for Hesai. Further reading: [Hesai Group \(HSAI.O\) - CEO/CFO Fresh Guidance on ASP, Actuator, and Cost Dynamics](#). **Chery's humanoid robot business updates:** Chery entered the robotics sector by establishing AiMOGA Robotics ([link](#)). **(1) 2026 shipments & revenues:** 500-1,000 humanoid robots plus 5,000-6,000 quadruped robot dogs. 2026/27 revenue is guided at Rmb400-500mn/Rmb800-1,000mn. **(2) ASP:** Humanoid robot wholesale price Rmb150-200k and robot dog Rmb10-20k. The robotics division is roughly at breakeven at a standalone level. Further reading: [Chery \(9973.HK\) - Superior Risk-Reward on 1.3x Asset-Turn; Lift 27E Export/TP to 2.54m/HK\\$43.0, Buy](#)

See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations

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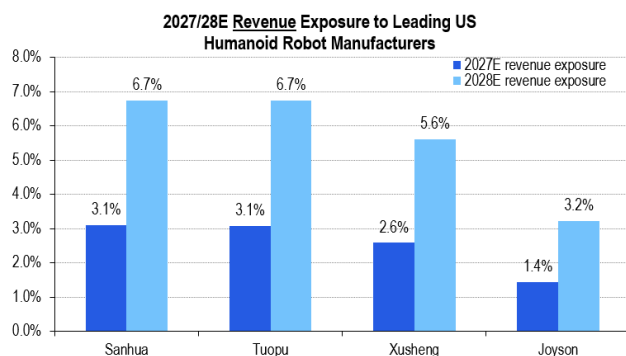
Figure 1. Weekly Production Run-Rate of Tesla Optimus



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Source: Citi Research Estimates, Citi Research Industry Checks, TESLARATI

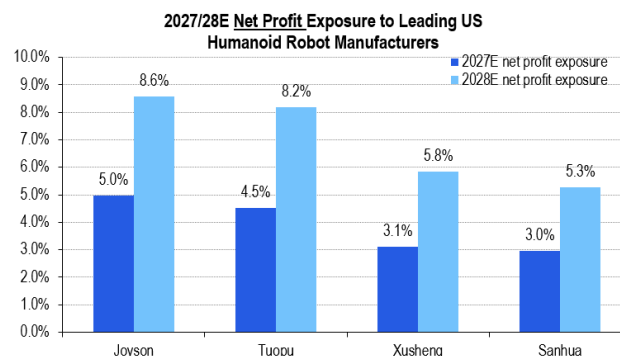
Figure 2. 2027/28E Revenue Exposure to Leading US Humanoid Robot Manufacturers



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Source: Citi Research Estimates

Figure 3. 2027/28E Net Profit Exposure to Leading US Humanoid Robot Manufacturers



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Figure 4. 2027/28E Revenue & Net Profit Exposure to Leading US Humanoid Robot Manufacturers

	2027E revenue exposure	2027E net profit exposure	Supplied products	2027E Assumptions			
				Robot production unit	Wallet share	ASP (Rmb)	NPM
Joyson	1.4%	5.0%	Smart head & structural parts	100,000	50%	20,000	12%
Sanhua	3.1%	3.0%	Actuators	100,000	25%	45,000	12%
Tuopu	3.1%	4.5%	Actuators	100,000	25%	45,000	12%
Xusheng	2.6%	3.1%	Structural parts	100,000	50%	3,000	12%

	2028E revenue exposure	2028E net profit exposure	Supplied products	2028E Assumptions			
				Robot production unit	Wallet share	ASP (Rmb)	NPM
Joyson	3.2%	8.6%	Smart head & structural parts	300,000	50%	18,000	10%
Sanhua	6.7%	5.3%	Actuators	300,000	25%	36,000	10%
Tuopu	6.7%	8.2%	Actuators	300,000	25%	36,000	10%
Xusheng	5.6%	5.8%	Structural parts	300,000	50%	2,400	10%

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Companies Mentioned:

Chery (9973.HK; HK\$26.36; 1; 18 Sep 26; 16:10) | Hesai Group (HSAI.O; US\$16.52; 1; 18 Sep 26; 16:00) | Hesai Group (2525.HK; HK\$16.45; 1; 18 Sep 26; 16:10) | Joyson Electronic (600699.SS; Rmb20.14; 1; 18 Sep 26; 15:00) | Joyson Electronic

(0699.HK; HK\$11.9; 1; 18 Sep 26; 16:10) | Ningbo Tuopu Group (601689.SS; Rmb45.0; 2; 18 Sep 26; 15:00) | Ningbo Xusheng Group (603305.SS; Rmb11.12; 2; 18 Sep 26; 15:00) | Sanhua (2050.HK; HK\$24.9; 2; 18 Sep 26; 16:10) | XPeng (XPEV.N; US\$10.62; 1; 18 Sep 26; 16:00) | XPeng (9868.HK; HK\$42.04; 1; 18 Sep 26; 16:10) | Zhejiang Sanhua Intelligent Controls (002050.SZ; Rmb35.31; 2; 18 Sep 26; 15:00)

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